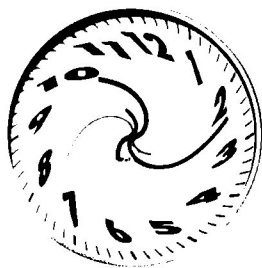


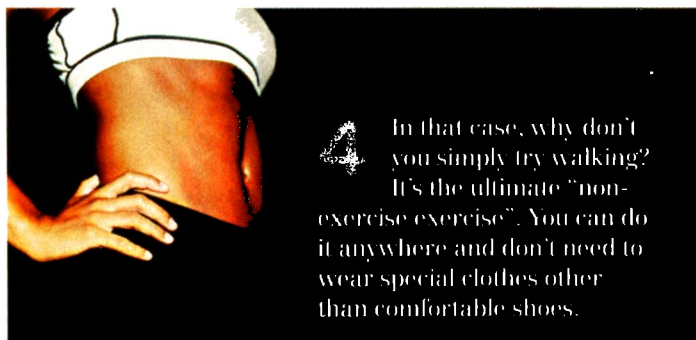
7 Excuse Busters for THE EXERCISE AVERSE

For the habitual workout procrastinator, here's how to head back to the gym

1 I DON'T HAVE THE TIME TO EXERCISE



The most common excuse. But actually it's a matter of priorities. Can't you really squeeze in three 20-minute sessions a week? What are you giving a higher priority to than your health? Watching tv? Working too many hours? It's just a question of will.



4 In that case, why don't you simply try walking? It's the ultimate "non-exercise exercise". You can do it anywhere and don't need to wear special clothes other than comfortable shoes.

EXERCISES DON'T REALLY WORK

It really depends on what you expect. You won't turn into a Slim Jim overnight, but exercises do burn calories. Again you won't get a super-toned body after one session in the gym. You simply can't look at workouts as an instant cure for years of overeating and neglecting your body. Regular exercise helps prevent heart attacks, strokes and diabetes.



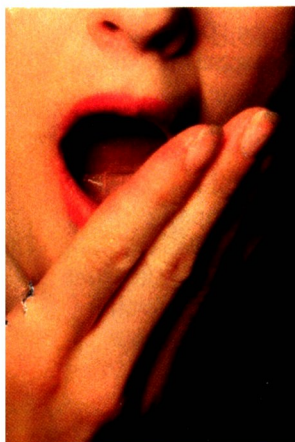
5 I AM TOO OLD FOR IT

You are never too old to walk. Several medical studies have shown that taking up a moderate exercise programme, such as walking, can help prevent major diseases at any age. Walkers live longer and walking regularly keeps your body flexible and your mind lucid in old age.



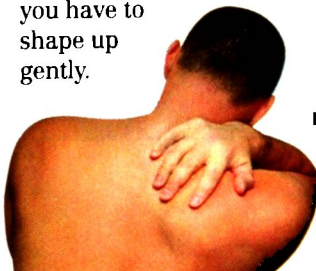
3 IT'S TOO BORING

If you find the idea of spending hours mindlessly on a machine down at the gym, avoid it. Look around instead for something you would love to do but just haven't got around to. Try tennis or golf, salsa-dancing or yoga—something that will spark your enthusiasm.



IT HURTS

If an activity doesn't feel good, don't do it. Listen to your body and choose an activity or a class with care. Injuries can result if you do too much too soon. Remember, you have to shape up gently.



7 I AM TOO TIRED

Are you sure it's not all in your mind? Because exercises can actually give you a boost. If you are not tired by a hard day of physical labour, just get moving. You will start feeling more lively. Regular exercise will also raise your general energy levels.

■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta**